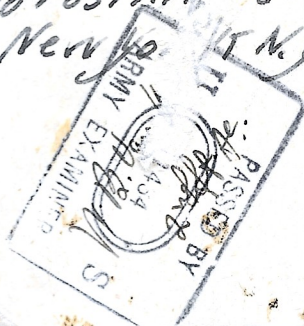


Pvt. O.T. Hoffstetter
A.S.N. 37416323

MAINTENANCE Division
39th Sta. Comp. Sg.
A.P.O. 635

% Postmaster
New York N.Y.



Miss MIRATHA DARROUGH
LUTHERAN HOSPITAL
NURSING HOME
ST. LOUIS 10, MO.

March 1, 1944

England

the body is but
not the mind.

Dearest Martha,

I got a little
time so I thought I would
write you. The boys
are always kidding me
about writing so much but
I love to write even though
I am very bad. I told them
the only way you will get
any letters is to write.

I ~~also~~ sent the to clippings
out of the Stars & Stripes.
I hope you like them. You
know why I put the
General Hospital in it
Because of you. The other

Small Chipping is when you
told me about you learning
how to jigger bug I thought
that is how you are going
to be after you teach me.
Now laugh, but wait until
you are in the Hospital
and see how hard you
laugh. Say you do not
have to go far do you.

Do you know that
there is 31 days in March and
we get paid for only 30
days. But last month we
had only 29 days. Say that
this is Leap year. Have
you been doing any leaping?
Why do you leap over here
a while.

I was talking to one of the

boys here. He has been here
22 months which is a long
time. He was just about
to be married to a girl back
home and he left the States.
They had the ring & the date
of the wedding all set.

After a year her letters
stop coming and in 13 months
she had to tell him that
she thought it was better
not to plan on a wedding
when he got back so he
say a.k. what else could he
say, about a month ago
he got his home town paper
and he saw in it that she
was married to some body
else. That is just one case
some of the boys has come

4

over with but the same
this paper to them too. And
some men who are married
are getting letters from their
wife that they are having
children now. Boy life is
sure a funny thing.

I am writing this all for
one purpose only. You have
say said a lot in your
letters & so have I. But
I want you to write me
& tell me the truth not
just save this to keep my
spirits up because I am over
here. I do not know how
far away we are I want
the truth. I suppose you
want the same thing too. I
do not blame you.

Well, I have been thinking a lot
 of you and about you. I guess
 I know the where I was at
 home. You never miss a good
 thing until you can not get
 it over see it. Every time there
 is a moon out I need a big
 one not a small one. I think
 now of you. I guess it's
 because of that time in the
 blackboat in St. Louis. I
 wonder if you remember that
 night? Well now to get
 back to the truth about this.

I do write to some girls
 back home. And I think
 about them too. I will
 not deny that.

But I guess I will
 have to get back home.

First and see a lot of people.
I guess & hope that you
are still around St. Louis.

Then I go again talking
about when I get home. Boy
will that be a long time until
I can do that but I guess that
is all the boys here live
far to see every body at
home.

In one of your letters
you gave me a penny for
my thoughts. Well, I have
a lot of them. And they cover
a great ~~to~~ range of things.
Like the dates we had.
And all the times I tried to
give you a penny for your
thoughts but you would
not talk. I was just.

wondering if they have
 change any? About the time
 we had to run back to
 the Hospital so you would
 be on duty in time. And
 then I waited until you
 got in to your uniform and
 I walk over to the Hospital
 with you. And the first
 date I had with you
 when we went to the
 show boat in the River.

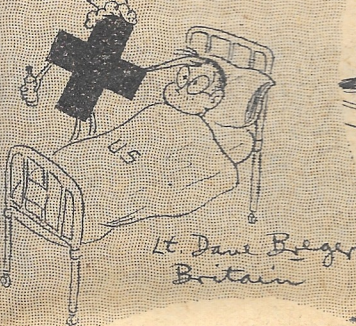
Now do you know that the
 dog who was with us
 that night is still at Wash-
 ington D. Now if I was
 smart I would be
 back at home and not
 in England. But all you
 need is just one word

on the paper and you can
get rid of this stupid guy.
But I hope you do not.

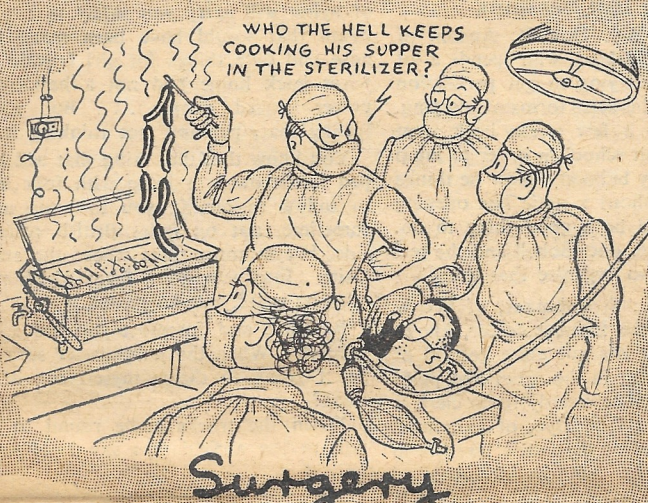
Say, do you know how
wretched so much that I
am on my last piece of paper
is this book. But I have
some more for the next letter
which will be very soon.

Mother wrote me that in
the States Air Mail will be
8 cents now so I know how hard
it is on your stamps. The best
thing is V-mail and if you type
it you can get a lot more
letter. And it is fast. But
you do what you want. I
never could tell a girl any thing.
3 cuts is good enough for me.
With kisses and love of them
I mean it.
Hop

General Hospital



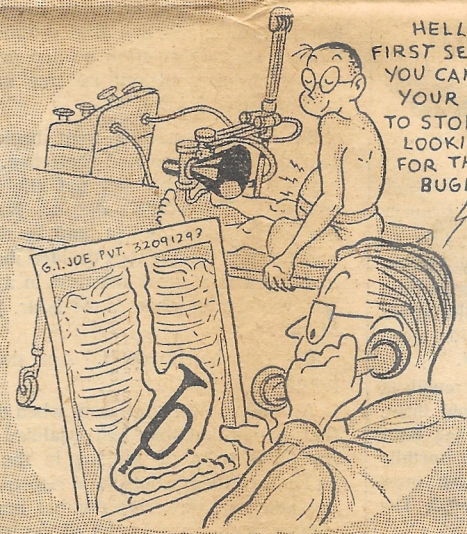
Medicine



Surgery



Dentistry



X-Ray



Laboratory

Take it from Eleanor Waite, an ARC club director in the ETO, "when you jitterbug with a man from Michigan—it's



murder, she says!" At a club dance the other night she was cutting a rug with a M/Sgt. from Petoskey, Mich. He was a hefty lad, and during the dance he tried a few new steps—giving the Red Cross worker's feet quite a clipping with his GI brogans. Miss Waite finished the dance, but reported to sick call next morning—where the X-ray revealed two broken toes!